

Object-Oriented Programming in Java

Lecture 2 - Imperative Concepts

Emily Lucia Antosch

HAW Hamburg

03.10.2025

Contents

1. Introduction	2
2. Simple Data Types	6
3. Comments and Identifiers	26
4. Operators	36
5. Type Conversion	47
6. Control Structures	58
7. License Notice	82

1. Introduction

1.1 Where Are We Now?

1. Introduction

- In the introduction, I gave you an overview of the topics for the upcoming lecture.
- You have also written your first program in Java!
- Today we'll cover **Imperative Concepts**.

1.1 Where Are We Now?

1. Introduction

1. **Imperative Concepts**
2. Classes and Objects
3. Class Library
4. Inheritance
5. Interfaces
6. Graphical User Interfaces
7. Exception Handling
8. Input and Output
9. Multithreading (Parallel Computing)

1.2 The Goal of This Chapter

- We will discuss imperative concepts in programming with Java.
- You will understand the simple data types in Java.
- You will control program flow with control structures and loops.
- You will apply the correct coding style.

2. Simple Data Types

? Question

How can a program remember its state?

? Question

How can a program remember its state?

- Variables that store the state in the computer's memory.
- The content of the memory on the computer is interpreted based on the **data type**.

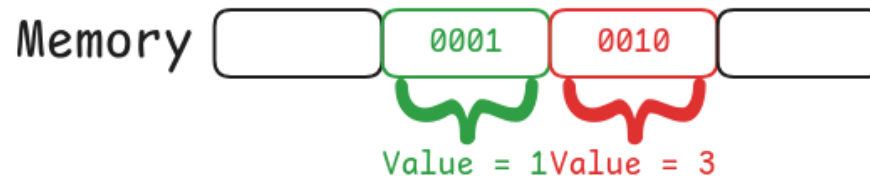


Figure 1: Memory in the computer with values from the program

? Question

Which data types do you already know from C?

? Question

Which data types do you already know from C?

- **int, char, float, double**
- **struct, enum, union**
- **void, bool**
- **Arrays with [] and Pointers with ***

2.2 Data Types in Java

2. Simple Data Types

The following data types are available in Java:

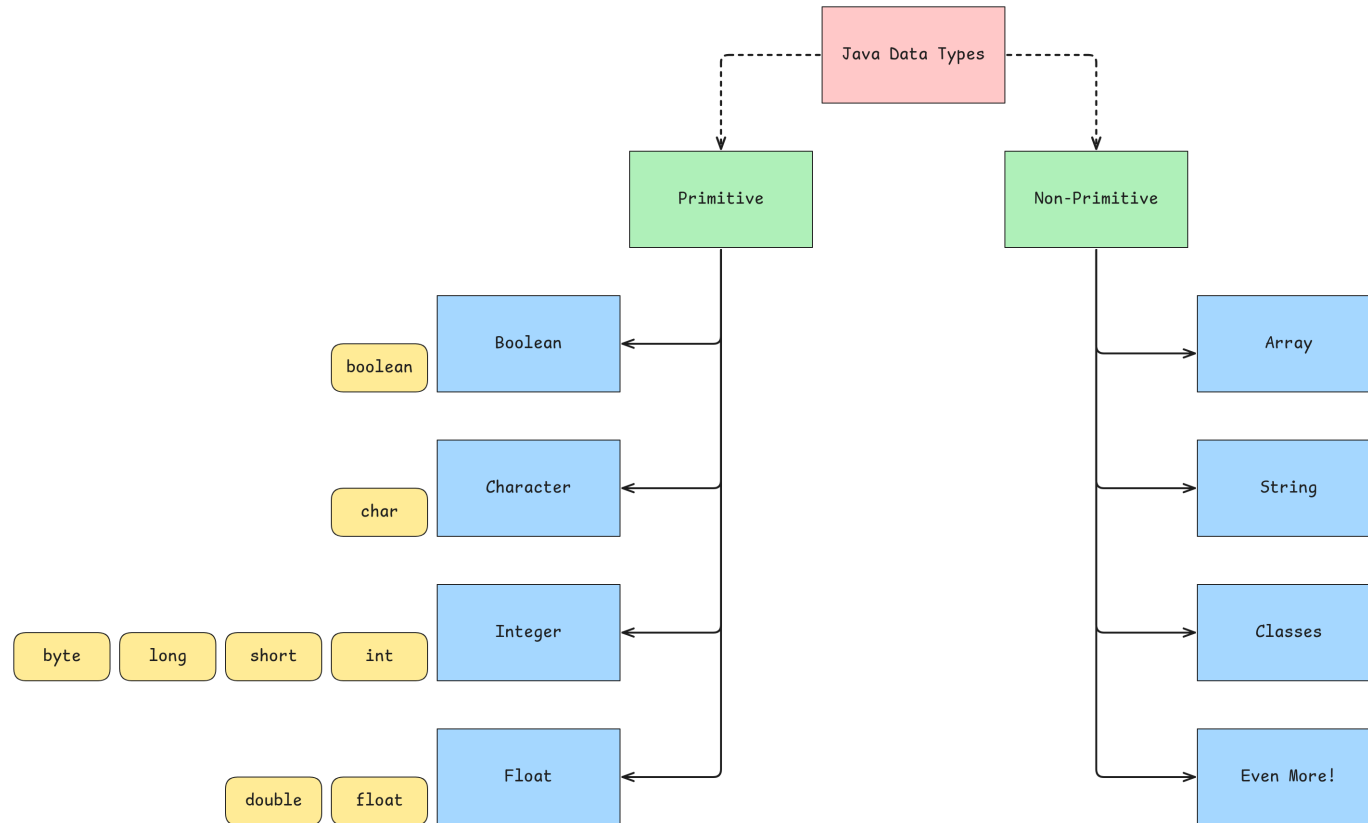


Figure 2: Data types in Java

- Memory sizes and the corresponding value ranges:

Type	Data Type	Size	Value
Integer	byte	1 Byte	-2^7 to $2^7 - 1$
	short	2 Byte	-2^{15} to $2^{15} - 1$
	int	4 Byte	-2^{31} to $2^{31} - 1$
	long	8 Byte	-2^{63} to $2^{63} - 1$
Character	char	2 Byte	0 to $2^{16} - 1$
Floating Point	float	4 Byte	
	double	8 Byte	
Truth	boolean	1 Bit	true or false

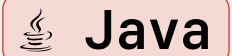
Table 1: Value ranges of data types

! Memorize

Variables must be declared before they can be used.

- A data type is written before the variable name.
- A declaration could look like this:

```
1 int a;  
2 float b;  
3 char c;
```

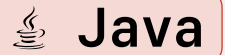


! Memorize

After declaration, a value can be assigned. This is called initialization.

- A value is assigned to the variable using the assignment operator =:

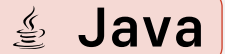
```
1  a = 5;  
2  b = 3.5;  
3  c = 'A';
```



! Memorize

Declaration and initialization can also be done in one step.
This is then called definition.

```
1 int a = 5;  
2 float b = 3.5;  
3 char c = 'A';
```



2.6 Scope of Variables

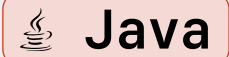
2. Simple Data Types

- Variables have a scope that is defined by the curly braces.
- Variables can be declared at any point in the code.
- The compiler prevents the use of variables that have not been initialized.

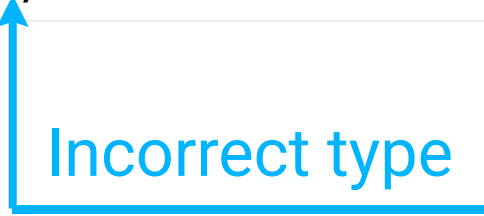
2.7 Type Correctness

- Types must be correct to avoid errors.
 - ▶ Unlike in C, values must be assigned to the correct data type.
 - ▶ The following would not work:

```
1 int a = 5;  
2 float b = a;
```



Incorrect type



? Question

What differences do you see between C and Java when it comes to data types?

- No composite data types in Java.
- No unsigned in Java.
- Memory sizes are fixed and guaranteed.
- Characters are encoded with 2 bytes.
 - ▶ 65,536 characters can be represented instead of 256.

! Memorize

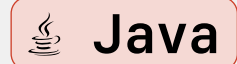
A **literal** is a constant, immutable number or string that appears directly in the code.

- So when you write a specific value directly in code, you use a literal.
- This is then not represented by a variable.

? Question

Why do you think the following code doesn't work?

```
1 float point = 3.1416;
```



? Question

Why do you think the following code doesn't work?

```
1 float point = 3.1416;
```



- The number is a fixed floating-point number that is interpreted by Java as **double**.
- Due to type correctness, the value is not stored in a **float** variable. The Java compiler gives an error.

? Question

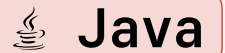
How would you correct the code?

? Question

How would you correct the code?

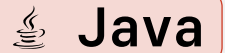
- You can write the value as a **float** literal:

```
1 float point = 3.1416f;
```



- Alternatively, you can store the value in a **double** variable:

```
1 double point = 3.1416d;
```

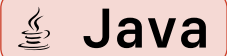


2.9 Constants

2. Simple Data Types

- We just had the example of the circle number π .
- In Java, there is the keyword to define constants.
- These can then no longer be changed.

```
1  final double PI = 3.1416;
```



- After a constant has been declared, it can no longer be changed.
The following code would therefore generate an error:

```
1  PI = 3;
```

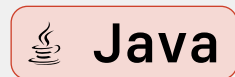


Task 1

We now want to create a console output:

- Open IntelliJ IDEA and open or create a new executable class.
- Try the following code:

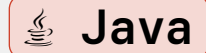
```
1 int age = 24;  
2 System.out.println(24);  
3 System.out.println(age);
```



Task 2

- Using the “+” operator, you can combine text and variables:

```
1 int age = 24;  
2 System.out.println("My age is " + 24);  
3 System.out.println("My age is " + age);
```



Tip

- Type `sout` in IntelliJ IDEA and press the Tab key. This saves time when writing `System.out.println()`!

? Question

What is a **Coding Style**? What does the term tell you?

? Question

What is a **Coding Style**? What does the term tell you?

- The coding style is a collection of rules that determine how code should be written.
- Uniform code is easier to read and maintain.

! Memorize

Compliance with the coding style will be evaluated in the exam!

2.12 Coding Style: Naming Conventions

2. Simple Data Types

- All names, and this applies to all identifiers, should be written in English!
- The following naming conventions should be followed:
 - ▶ Classes: **CamelCase**
 - ▶ Methods and variables: **camelCase**
 - ▶ Constants: **UPPER_CASE**
 - ▶ Packages: **lowercase**



Tip

From my experience: Make your variables as meaningful as possible! Then the name can also be longer.

3. Comments and Identifiers

3.1 Character Set

3. Comments and Identifiers

- As already mentioned, Java uses the Unicode character set.
- This means more characters are possible (65,536 to be exact).
- So you can write your comments in German, English, or Chinese without major restrictions.
- However, I would ask you to write your comments in **German** or **English**.

! Memorize

Since your keyboard doesn't have 65,536 characters, you can also copy and paste the characters. Alternatively for 😊 :

```
1 System.out.println("\u{1F600}");
```



? Question

What do you think about the following statement? Why are comments important?

” Quote

Make the code readable? Who else is supposed to read this?

— Many Developers

- Comments are important for documenting code and improving maintainability.
- Both users of the code and the developers will need to understand the code. Comments are essential for this.

! Memorize

Not the quantity, but the quality of comments is crucial!
Always comment directly while you are programming!

? Question

What is the difference between a **block comment** and a **line comment**?

? Question

What is the difference between a **block comment** and a **line comment**?

- **Line comments** start with `//` and end at the end of the line.
- **Block comments** start with `/*` and end with `*/`.

3.2 Comments

3. Comments and Identifiers

- Example of a line comment:

```
1 // This is a line comment
2 int distance; // Euclidean distance between a and b
```



- Example of a block comment:

```
1 /* The calculation of the Euclidean distance
   follows these steps:
2     1. Calculate the difference of coordinates
3     2. Square the difference
4     ... */
```



- All things that you name in Java are called **identifiers**. Many things you write need a name!

! Memorize

- Follow these rules for identifiers:
 - ▶ Letters, numbers, underscores, and dollar signs are allowed.
 - ▶ The first character may not be a number.
 - ▶ Case sensitivity is observed.
 - ▶ No spaces or keywords.
 - ▶ Not the literals `true`, `false`, or `null`.

3.3 Identifiers

3. Comments and Identifiers

- All reserved keywords in Java:

abstract	double	int	super
assert	else	interface	switch
boolean	enum	long	synchronized
break	extends	native	this
byte	final	new	throw
case	finally	package	throws
catch	float	private	transient
char	for	protected	try
class	goto	public	void
const	if	return	volatile
continue	implements	short	while
default	import	static	
do	instanceof	strictfp	

? Question

Which of the identifiers are **allowed** in your opinion and why?

1 `int length;`

2 `int länge;`

3 `int maxLength;`

4 `int max_length;`

5 `int _max_length;`

6 `int max-length;`

7 `int !maxLength;`



Java

3.3 Identifiers

3. Comments and Identifiers

```
8
9    int 3dlength;
10   String öpnevKosten;
11   String €kosten;
12   String kostenin€
13   String €;
14   int long;
15   int c.o.s.t;
16   String @cost;
```

4. Operators

4.1 Operators

- There are the usual arithmetic operators.
- In general, operators are also evaluated from left to right.

Operator	Name	Example	Priority
+	Prefix	a = 7	1
-	Prefix	a = -7	1
++	Increment	++count, count++	1
--	Decrement	--count, count--	1
*	Multiplication	area = length * width	2
/	Division	mean = sum / count	2
%	Modulo	11 % 4 (ergibt 3)	2
+	Addition	a = b + c	3
-	Substraction	a = b - c	3

Table 1: Value ranges of data types

4.2 Increment and Decrement

- There are also the same operators for incrementing and decrementing as in C.

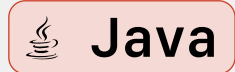
Operator	Type	Value of Expression	Change of a
<code>++a</code>	Prefix	<code>a + 1</code>	<code>a = a + 1</code>
<code>a++</code>	Postfix	<code>a</code>	<code>a = a + 1</code>
<code>--a</code>	Prefix	<code>a - 1</code>	<code>a = a - 1</code>
<code>a--</code>	Postfix	<code>a</code>	<code>a = a - 1</code>

Table 2: Value ranges of data types

? Question

Think about it: What will appear on the console here?

```
1  int a = 1;
2  System.out.println("++a : " + ++a);
3  System.out.println("a   : " + a);
4  System.out.println("a++ : " + a++);
5  System.out.println("--a : " + --a);
6  System.out.println("a-- : " + a--);
```



Java

4.3 Comparison Operators

- There are also the same comparison operators as in C!

Operator	Name	Priority
<	less than	5
<=	less than or equal to	5
>	larger than	5
>=	larger than or equal to	5
==	equal to	6
!=	not equal to	6

Table 3: Value ranges of data types

? Question

Think about it: What happens here?

```
1 int a = 7, b = 4;  
2 boolean parentheses = (a > b) == (a <= b);  
3 boolean priorities = a > b == a <= b;  
4 System.out.println(parentheses);  
5 System.out.println(priorities);
```

**Java**

4.4 Logical Operators

- The result of logical operators is always a truth value, which is represented as `boolean` in Java.

Operator	Name	Priority
!	NOT	1
^	XOR	8
&&	AND	10
	OR	11

Table 4: Value ranges of data types

! Memorize

- With logical operators, the right operand is not executed if the result is already determined. In the following example, `a` is not evaluated.
- Example: `(true || a)`
- This is called **Short Circuit**.
- This becomes interesting when the right operand is, for example, a function/method.

? Question

Think about it again: What happens in the following code?

```
1 int a = 3, b = 4;  
2 System.out.println((++a == b) || (a++ > b));  
3 System.out.println("a = " + a);
```



4.5 Assignment Operators

- As in C, there are also assignment operators in Java. These can also be combined with other operators.
- The placeholder `<op>` stands for `*`, `/`, `+` and `-`, among others.

Operator	Name	Priority
<code>=</code>	Assignment	13
<code><op>=</code>	Combined Assignment: <code>a <op>= b</code> $\Leftrightarrow$ <code>a = a <op> b</code>	13

Table 5: Value ranges of data types

? Question

One last time: What happens in this code?

```
1  int a = 1;
2  a += 2;
3  System.out.println(a);
4  System.out.println(a *= --a);
5  System.out.println(a *= -a++);
6  System.out.println(a /= 10);
```



Java

5. Type Conversion

5.1 Type Conversion

- As a reminder: Type correctness prevents variables from getting a value that does not correspond to their data type.
- This prevents errors and makes the code safer.



Warning

However, a variable of type `int` does not fit into a variable of type `byte`. How can you still store the value from `int` in a `byte` variable?



Idea

You can simply write that you want this explicitly!

```
1 int a = 80;  
2 byte b = (byte) a;  
3 System.out.println(b);
```



Java

? Question

What happens in the following code?

```
1 double a = 128.38;
2 int b = (int) a;
3 byte c = (byte) a;
4 System.out.println("double: " + a);
5 System.out.println("int : " + b);
6 System.out.println("byte : " + c);
```

**Java**

? Question

What happens when you store the value 128 in a byte variable?

? Question

What happens when you store the value 128 in a byte variable?

- Since the data type can only store values from -128 to 127, the value will overflow.
- The result will be a negative number. In this case it will be -128.

! Memorize

- Principle of implicit type conversion:
 - ▶ No data loss when assigning from a smaller to a larger type.
 - ▶ The cast operator is not necessary.
 - ▶ Automatic conversion takes place.



Example

- `short` (-32,768 to 32,767) fits into `int` (-2,147,483,648 to 2,147,483,647).

```
1 short a = 71;
```

```
2 int b = (int) a;
```

```
3 int c = a;
```



Java

? Question

Think about it: Which of the following lines will compile?

```
1 short a = 1024;
```

```
2 long b = a;
```

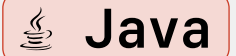
```
3 float c = b;
```

**Java**

5.2 Implicit Type Conversion

5. Type Conversion

```
1 char d = 'A';  
2 short e = d;  
3 int f = d;
```



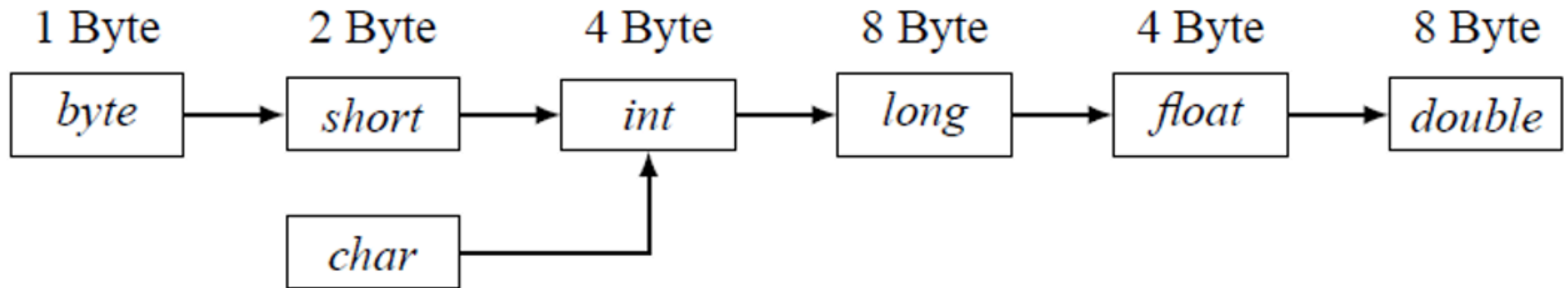


Figure 1: Implicit type conversion in Java

! Memorize

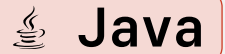
- Integer types char and short each have 2 bytes, but char is an **unsigned** data type.
 - ▶ Value range char: 0 to 65,535
 - ▶ Value range short: -32,768 to 32,767
- Not all long values can be represented in float (potential data loss!).

6. Control Structures

! Memorize

If statements are the simplest form of control structures. They allow statements to be executed only when a condition is met.

```
1 if (condition) {  
2     statements  
3 }
```

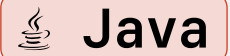


6.1 if Statement

6. Control Structures

- The condition must always be a boolean, unlike in C.
- Statements are only executed when the condition is true (true).
- With only one statement, the curly braces can be omitted.

```
1  int a = 4, b = 8;  
2      int maximum = a;  
3  
4      if (b > maximum) {  
5          maximum = b;  
6      }
```

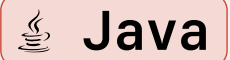


Java

6.2 if-else Statement

Using an `else` statement, you can specify a block that is executed when the condition is not met.

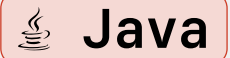
```
1  if (condition) {  
2      statements 1  
3  } else {  
4      statements 2  
5  }
```



6.2 if-else Statement

Statement 2 in the above example is executed when the condition is false.

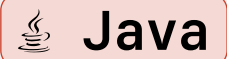
```
1  int a = 4, b = 8;
2  int maximum;
3
4  if (a > b) {
5      maximum = a;
6  } else {
7      maximum = b;
8  }
```



6.3 The ? Operator

For simple assignment using `if-else` statements, an expression in this form can be used:

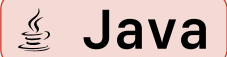
```
1 (condition) ? expression 1 : expression 2;
```



- Condition `true`: expression 1 is used
- Condition `false`: expression 2 is used

```
1 int a = 4, b = 8;
```

```
2 int maximum = (a > b) ? a : b;
```



Task 3

- Given is an integer `weekDay` between 1 and 7.
- It corresponds to: 1 = Monday, 2 = Tuesday, 3 = Wednesday, etc.

Generate the following console outputs depending on the value:

- Monday to Friday: "Working"
- Saturday: "Shopping"
- Sunday: "Resting"



Example

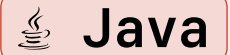
```
1 byte weekDay = 3;  
2  
3 if (weekDay <= 5) {  
4     System.out.println("Working");  
5 } else if (weekDay == 6) {  
6     System.out.println("Shopping");  
7 } else if (weekDay == 7) {  
8     System.out.println("Resting");  
9 }
```

**Java**

6.5 switch Statement

With the `switch` statement, `if-else` statements can be simplified.

```
1  switch (expression) {  
2      case value 1:  
3          statements  
4      break;  
5      case value 2:  
6          ...  
7      default:  
8          statements  
9  }
```



6.5 switch Statement

6. Control Structures

- Expression is e.g. an integer variable (except type `long`) or a `String` (from Java 7).
- Statements, `break` and `default` are optional.
- Multiple case labels directly in succession are allowed.
- Jump to ...
 - ▶ case label, if it has the value of the expression
 - ▶ `default`, if no matching case label
 - ▶ End of `switch` block, if no matching case label and no `default`
- From case label or `default` continue until `break` or end of `switch` block

Task 4

Implement a solution for task 3 as a `switch` statement

6.5 switch Statement

6. Control Structures

```
1  switch (weekDay) {  
2      case 1:  
3      case 2:  
4      case 3:  
5      case 4:  
6      case 5:  
7          System.out.println("Working");  
8          break;  
9      case 6:  
10         System.out.println("Shopping");  
11         break;
```



Java

6.5 switch Statement

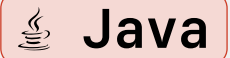
6. Control Structures

```
12     case 7:  
13         System.out.println("Resting");  
14         break;  
15     default:  
16         System.out.println("I don't know that day...");  
17 }
```

6.6 while Loop

With the `while` loop, a statement is executed as long as the condition is `true`.

```
1 while (condition) {  
2     statements  
3 }
```



- If the condition is already false at the beginning, the statement is never executed.
- Also called a **head-controlled** or **rejecting** loop.

6.6 while Loop

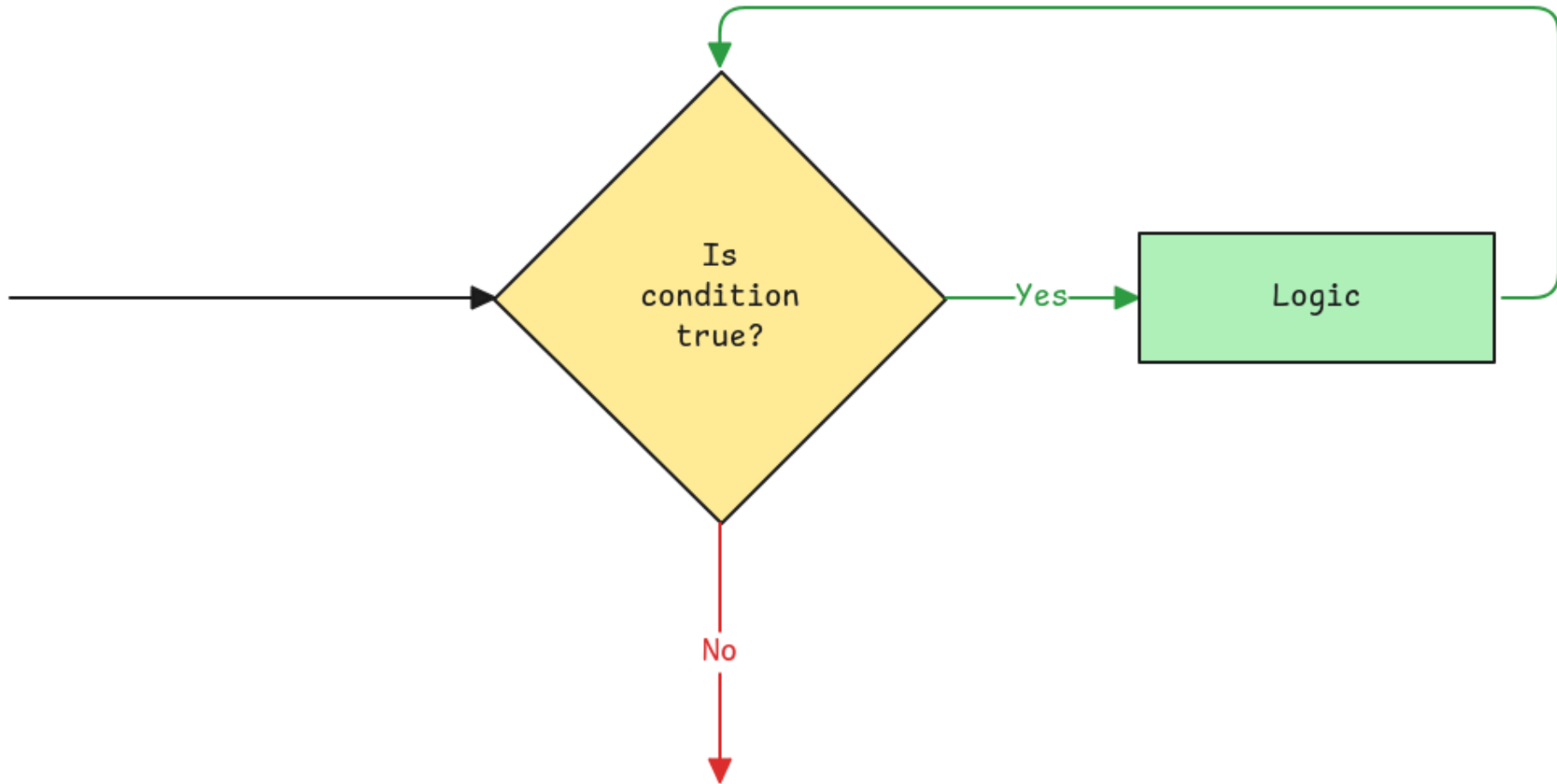
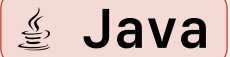


Figure 2: while-Schleife in Java

6.7 do-while Loop

With the `do-while` loop, a statement is executed at least once. If the condition is `true`, the statement is executed again.

```
1  do {  
2      statements  
3  } while (condition);
```



- Also called a **foot-controlled** or **non-rejecting** loop.

6.7 do-while Loop

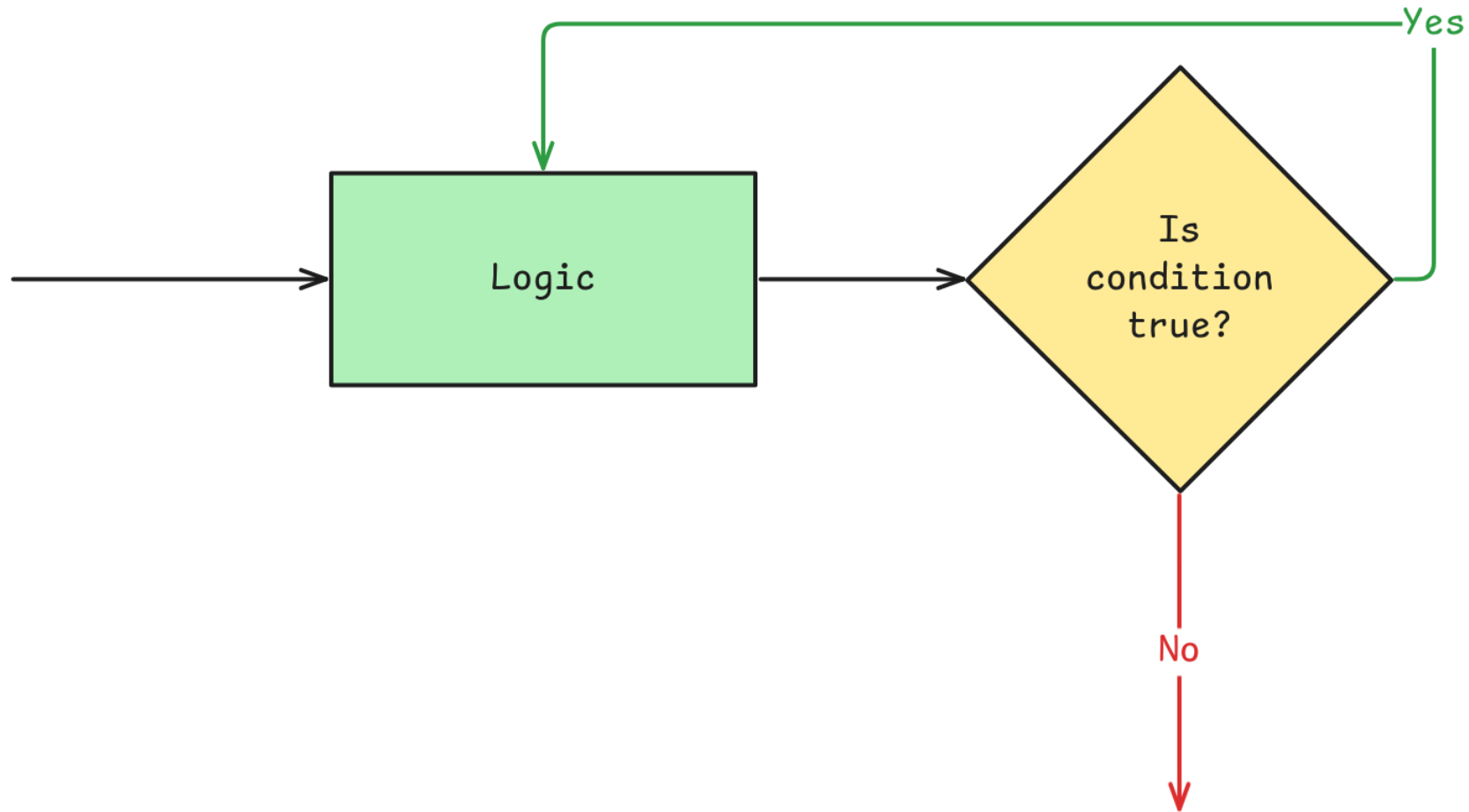
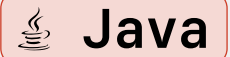


Figure 3: do-while-Schleife in Java

6.8 for Loop

With the `for` loop, you can repeat a statement a certain number of times.

```
1  for (init; condition; update) {  
2      statements  
3  }
```



- If condition is `false`, the statement is never executed.
- Init is executed only once, but always.
- Update is executed after each iteration.

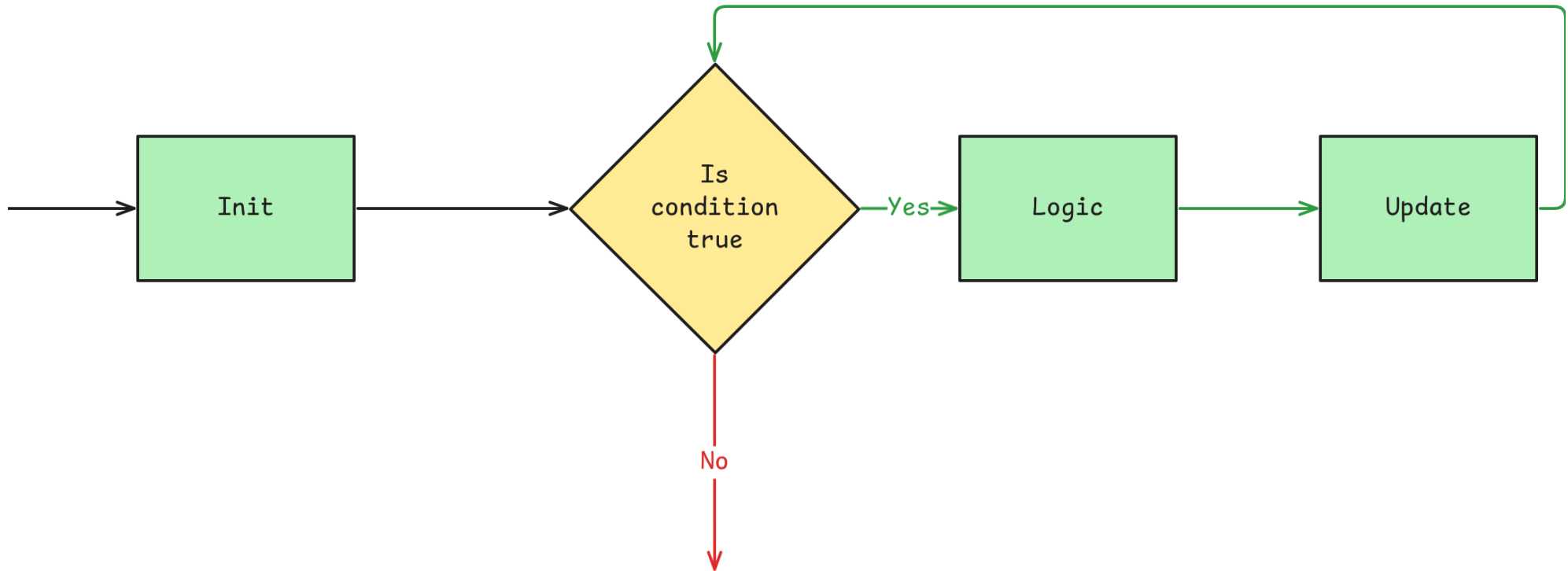


Figure 4: for-Schleife in Java

6.9 Jump Statements

Using jump statements, you can control the program flow. `break` terminates the loop and `continue` jumps to the next loop iteration.

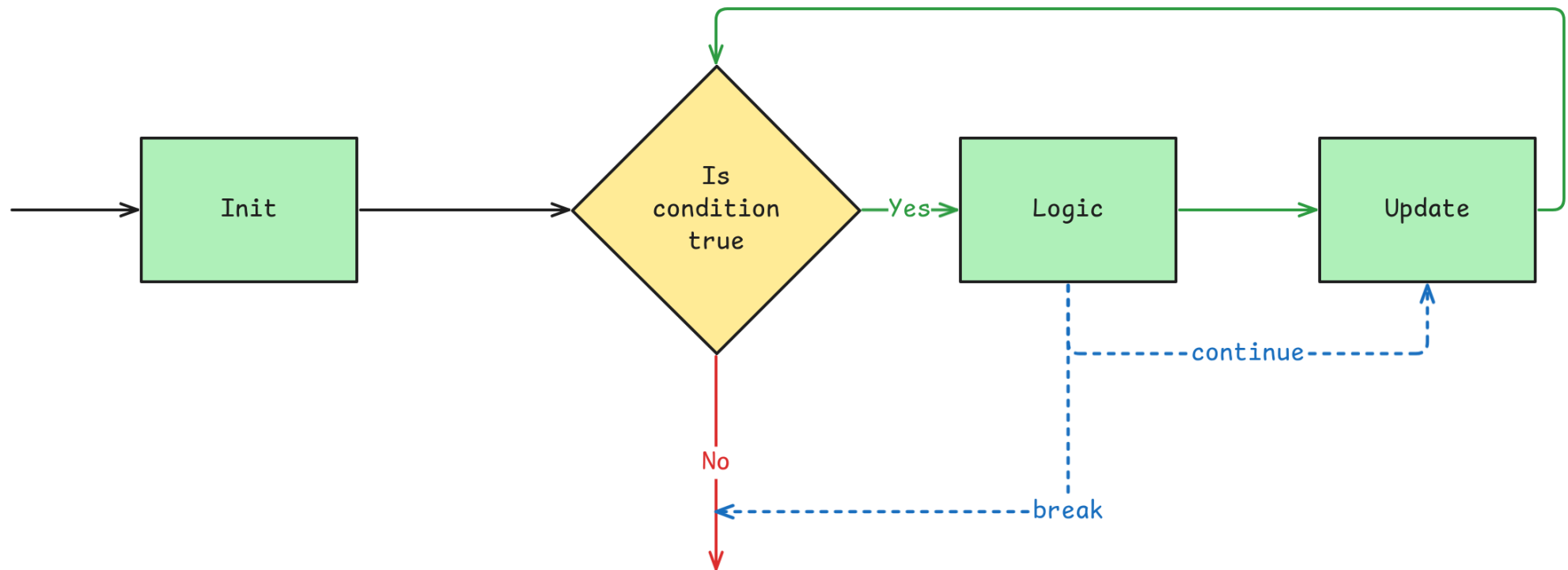
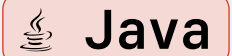


Figure 5: Visualisierung von `break` und `continue` in Java

? Question

What happens in the following code?

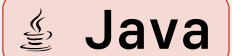
```
1 System.out.println("Break (when i == 2):");
2 for (int i = 0; i <= 4; i++) {
3     if (i == 2) {
4         break;
5     }
6     System.out.println("  i = " + i);
7 }
```



? Question

What happens in the following code?

```
1 System.out.println("\nContinue (when i == 2):");
2 for (int i = 0; i <= 4; i++) {
3     if (i == 2) {
4         continue;
5     }
6     System.out.println("  i = " + i);
7 }
```



- As already mentioned, coding style is important. Therefore, there is also a coding style for control structures.
- Opening curly braces are written on the same line as the control structure (this applies to all opening braces).
- After a closing curly brace, a line break is made. With `else`, the closing brace is on the same line.



Example

```
1  int a = 4, b = 8;
2      int maximum;
3
4  if (a > b) {
5      maximum = a;
6  } else {
7      maximum = b;
8  }
```



Java

7. License Notice

7.1 Attribution

- This work is shared under the CC BY-NC-SA 4.0 License and the respective Public License
- <https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by-nc-sa/4.0/>
- This work is based off of the work Prof. Dr. Marc Hensel.
- Some of the images and texts, as well as the layout were changed.
- The base material was supplied in private, therefore the link to the source cannot be shared with the audience.